

Cover to *Iron Man (1998) #63* by Paolo Rivera.

his munitions have caused.

Granov, who has provided designs for all three *Iron Man* films, says, "The *Extremis* book Warren and I did has been a constant guide with the *Iron Man* movies, which is fairly surprising as it's only six issues among decades of the character's history. But on the other hand, I think, it brought a sense of realism and weight to the character which was hard to pin down previously, possibly because of those decades of history. *Extremis* gave Iron Man a focus, and I attempted to make it as cinematic as possible."

Tony Stark had always been a self-made man, a magnate whose riches derived from his unmatched genius as an inventor. Now, inspired by the real-world terrorists of the 21st century, Ellis and Granov gave Tony the perfect setting to build his first armor: the cave.

The filmmakers seized on that image. "I think he was always a super hero," Broussard says, "but he just got his head right in a cave in Afghanistan, and that's when he became Iron Man. He started to embrace that in the last few seconds of the first film, then spent *Iron Man 2* trying to figure out exactly what that means—kind of overcorrecting and saying, 'I don't need anyone's help, I can do this on my own,' before growing a little bit at the end of that film. And then, of course, in *The Avengers*, he does learn what teamwork means, and he learns what it means to be a super hero in the larger context of the world."

In developing the villains for this third installment of the series, the filmmakers looked, once again, to Ellis and Granov's *Extremis*. In *Iron Man 3*, industrialist Aldrich Killian develops the Extremis process, a bioengineering formula that literally rewrites the human body from the inside out.

Marvel Comics Executive Editor Tom Brevoort says, "In the original *Extremis* comic-book story, writer Warren Ellis took his cues from the school of scientific thought that believes that there are markers within the human genetic code designed to allow us to 'hack' our own bodies, and to make improvements at the genetic level. Such a process could be used for a variety of purposes—everything from curing terminal diseases to weaponizing the human body itself. In the original story, there's only a single person augmented by the Extremis enhancile—the extremist militia member Mallen. The film, on the other hand, goes all-in by presenting a number of Extremis-enhanced subjects."

The villains in *Iron Man 3* aren't all super-soldiers and inventors. Another figure, the mysterious Mandarin, was pulled from the earliest Iron Man comics and given a complete makeover.

Oddly enough, the Mandarin had been planned as a